

Week 11: DNA

BIG IDEA

Halfway through the science unit, pause and take stock: how are your relationships and question-welcoming culture doing, and how are students actually tracking? Don't be afraid to slow down and revisit concepts, and lean on the provided misconceptions and simple examples, like Sean's book analogy for DNA.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Take a step back this week and analyze your relationships: is the culture of welcome questions, honesty, and developing faith actually growing?
- Ask how new students are assimilating and whether relationships are furthering and getting better since the beginning.
- Honestly assess how students are tracking; some may nod along without getting it, some may be fired up and digging, and everywhere in between.
- Don't be afraid to slow down, pull back, and revisit concepts; don't move forward until you're certain your students are ready.
- The provided misconceptions are a clear window into the underlying narrative students are actually reading in their school textbooks.
- Use the right examples to simplify difficult concepts; the best is Sean's use of simply describing a book to help us understand DNA.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. How are your relationships with students going, and do they feel safe being honest with you and one another?
2. Where are your students on the spectrum: nodding without understanding, fired up and asking great questions, or in between?
3. Which concepts from this unit might you need to slow down and revisit before moving forward?
4. What simple examples, like describing a book to explain DNA, could you use to simplify difficult concepts?

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